

0.0.1 Don't Fear Merits

1. This indeed was said by the Auspicious One, said by the Arahant, as heard by me:

2. Do not be afraid of merits, O bhikkhus. It is of happiness, O bhikkhus, that this is spoken of, of what is wished for, of what is agreeable, of what is dear, of what is pleasing, that is to say merits. Now I, O bhikkhus, recall experiencing for a long time the results of merits that were wished for, agreeable, dear, pleasing. Having developed a mind of metta for seven years, for seven world cycles I did not come back to this world. During the contracting phase of an aeon, I was headed to the Abhassara [brahma world]. During the expansion phase of the aeon, I arose in an empty brahma palace. There I was Brahmā, the Great Brahmā, the Con-

māpuññabhāyī suttaṃ

vuttaṃ hetamaṃ bhagavatā. vuttavarahatā'ti me suttaṃ.

mā bhikkhave puññānaṃ bhāyittha. sukhassetamaṃ bhikkhave adivacanamaṃ iṭṭhassa kantassa piyassa manāpassa yadidaṃ puññāni. abhijānāmi kho panāhaṃ bhikkhave dīgharattaṃ katānaṃ puññānaṃ iṭṭhaṃ kantaṃ piyamaṃ manāpaṃ vipākaṃ paccanūbhūtaṃ. satta vassāni mettacittaṃ bhāvetvā satta saṃvaṭṭavivaṭṭakappena yimaṃ lokaṃ punarāgamāsim. saṃvaṭṭamāne sudaṃ bhikkhave kappe ābhassarūpago homi. vivaṭṭamāne kappe suññaṃ buhmavi-

queror, the Unconquered, the All Seeing, the Wielder of Power. For thirty six times, O bhikkhus, I was Sakka, the ruler of the devas. For many hundreds of times I was a wheel turning monarch, a righteous king ruling by the dhamma, victorious king of the world who has attained stability of the country, endowed with the seven gems. What to speak of mere national kingship? It occurred to me, O bhikkhus: “Of what fruits of kamma, of what results of kamma, is it that at present I am of such great power, such great might?” It occurred to me, O bhikkhus: “It is of these three fruits of kamma, of these three results of kamma, that at present I am of such great power, such great might. “That is: Generosity, taming and self-control.””

mānaṃ upapajjāmi. tatra sudam bhikkhave brahmā homi mahābrahmā abhibhu anabhibhūto aññadatthudaso vasavattī. chattimsakkhattuṃ kho panāhaṃ bhikkhave sakko ahoṣiṃ devānamindo. anekasatakkhattuṃ rājā ahoṣiṃ cakkevattī dhammiko dhammarājā cāturato vijitāvī janapadatthāvariyaṃ patto satataranasampanno. ko pana vādo padesarajjassa? tassa mayhaṃ bhikkhave etadahosi: 'kissa nu kho me idaṃ kammassa phalaṃ, kissa kammassa vipāko, yenāhaṃ etarahi evaṃ mahiddhiko evaṃ mahānubhāvo'ti. tassa mayhaṃ bhikkhave etadahosi: tiṇṇaṃ kho me idaṃ kam-

3. This is the meaning of what the Auspicious One said. Thus, this was said there:

Who would practice mer-
its
of the highest kind, with
pleasant consequences;
should develop a mind of
metta,
with generosity and
wholesome conduct.

Having developed these
dhammas,
three producers of plea-
sure;
the wise one arises,
in an unafflictive pleas-
ant world.

mānaṃ phalaṃ, tiṇ-
ṇaṃ kammānaṃ vi-
pāko, yenāhaṃ eta-
rahi evaṃ mahid-
dhiko evaṃ mahā-
nubhāvo'ti seyya-
thīdaṃ: dānassa da-
massa saññaṃassā'ti.

etamatthaṃ bha-
gavā avoca. tatthe-
taṃ iti vuccati:

puññaṃeva so sik-
kheyya,
āyataggaṃ sukhudra-
yaṃ;
dānañca samacari-
yañca,
mettacittañca bhā-
vaye.

ete dhamme bhāvayi-
tvā,
tayo sukhasamudday;
abyāpajjhaṃ sukhaṃ
lokaṃ,
paṇḍito upapajjati'tī.

4. “This too is the meaning of what was said by the Auspicious One. Thus was heard by me”. ayampi atthe vutto bhagavatā. iti me sutanti.

